

The Year You Taught Us

Ananya & Rohan

For Kiara. One day you'll read how little we knew, and how much you taught us anyway.

Mom & Dad

EMPEIRYA

The Year You Taught Us

Our first year as parents, from the day you were born to your first birthday

Ananya & Rohan

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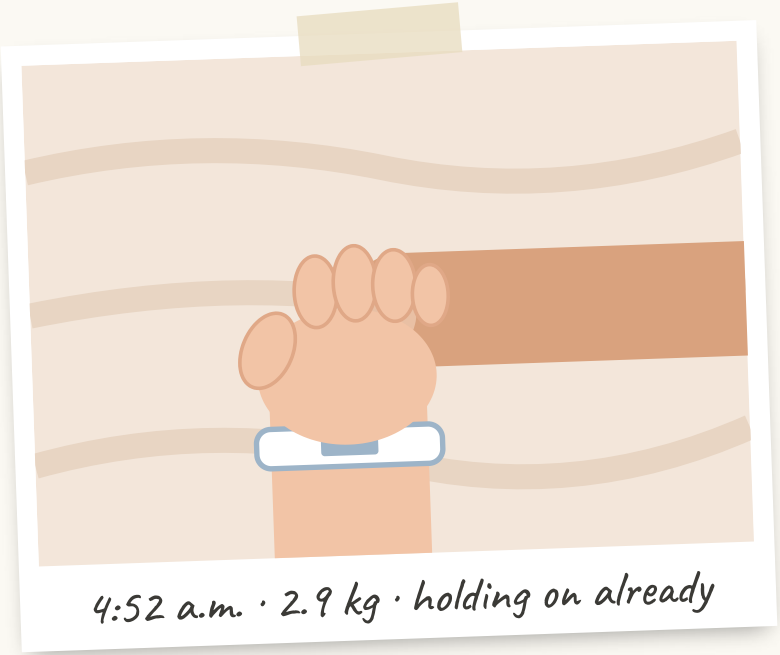
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MONTH 0

The day you arrived



4:52 a.m. · 2.9 kg · holding on already

WHAT HAPPENED

Kiara arrived at 4:52 in the morning after nineteen hours of labour, much louder than anyone expected.

WHAT I FELT

Love, yes. And terror. The nurse showed me how to hold her head, then left the room. I didn't move for an hour.

WHAT I LEARNED

You don't need to know everything on day one. You only need to show up for the next feed.

The nights



3:12 a.m., again

For eleven weeks we slept in two-hour pieces. I cried in the bathroom more than once, then went back in.

Ask for help before you're desperate. The week Rohan took the 2 a.m. feed, everything changed.

The fever

WHAT HAPPENED

103°F at two in the morning. We drove to the hospital in our night clothes.

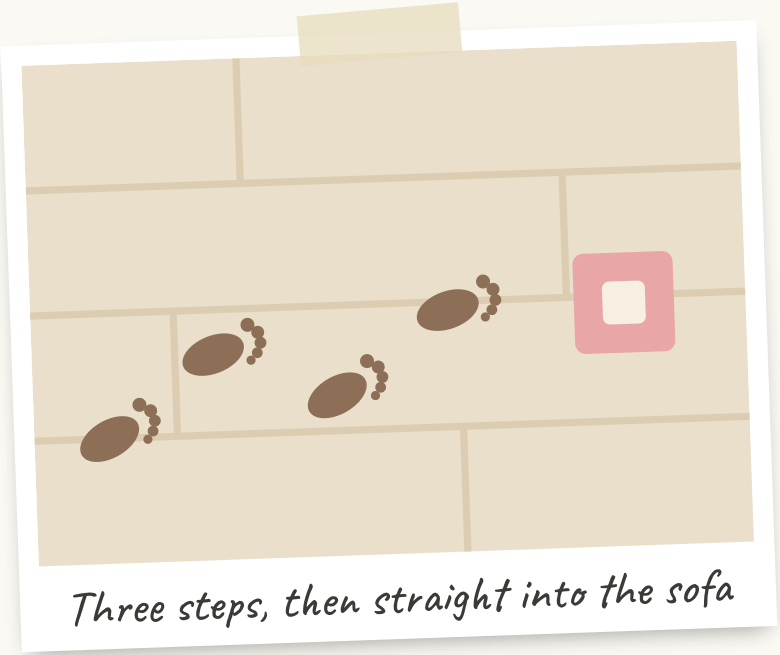
WHAT WE TRIED

We had written down every feed and every temperature with the time. The doctor said it was the most useful thing we brought.

WHAT I LEARNED

Write things down. In a panic, your notes remember what you can't.

First steps



Three steps, then straight into the sofa

She let go of the table, took three steps and fell into my arms. Eleven months of tired nights, and this was the payoff.

MONTH 12

One year



365 days	1,100+ night feeds
9.1 kg from 2.9 kg	4 teeth

What I'd tell any new parent

1. Lower the bar for everything except sleep and kindness. The house can be a mess.

2. Take one photo every day. You won't remember month four, and you'll want to.

3. Your baby doesn't need a perfect parent. She needs the same tired one, again and again.

Hear her first laugh
Scan to play the recording from month four.

Open on your 18th birthday



For Kiara

In the app, this letter stays sealed until Kiara turns eighteen.

Left blank for Kiara to write in, someday.

EMPEIRYA

Printed for the Rao family